Learning Journal 3

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Course: SOEN 6841 Software Project Management

Journal URL:
[https://github.com/Mihir8754/mihir8754/blob/SOEN_6841_LR's/Learning%20Journal%201.docx]

Dates Range of activities: 04/02/25 – 21/02/25

Date of the journal: 22/02/25

Chapter 5

Key Concepts Learned:	Configuration management is essential for software projects to manage multiple artifacts throughout the development lifecycle. A configuration management system ensures documents and work products are stored securely and can be accessed efficiently. Continuous integration plays a crucial role in managing software builds, ensuring all new changes are integrated properly.
Application in Real Projects:	Proper configuration management prevents issues such as working on outdated versions of software components. Version control and central repositories facilitate seamless collaboration between distributed teams. Role-based access ensures secure and structured control over project documents and work products.
Peer Interactions:	Discussed the importance of centralized vs. decentralized configuration management systems. Explored how companies implement role-based permissions to maintain document security.
Challenges Faced:	Understanding the technical implementation of configuration management tools in real-world scenarios. Managing the complexity of access control for different project team members.
Personal development activities:	Researched various configuration management tools such as Git, SVN, and Perforce. Practiced setting up a simple version control system to understand tagging and branching mechanisms.
Goals for the Next Week:	Explore the impact of configuration management on Agile development workflows. Investigate industry case studies on successful implementation of configuration management systems. Identify key metrics used to evaluate the effectiveness of configuration management processes.

Chapter 6

Key Concepts Learned:	Project planning balances quality, schedule, cost, and organizational benefits. Work Breakdown Structure (WBS) helps in structuring project tasks and milestones. Resource allocation varies by phase; construction and testing require the most resources. The necessity of integrating project risk assessment into the planning phase.
Application in Real Projects:	Proper project planning ensures that tasks are executed efficiently, avoiding bottlenecks. The critical path method (CPM) helps identify dependencies and optimize project scheduling. Goldratt's critical chain method mitigates uncertainty and ensures buffer management.
Peer Interactions:	Discussed top-down vs. bottom-up planning approaches and their suitability for different projects. Explored case studies on iterative project planning in Agile environments. Shared insights on project tracking tools like Microsoft Project and Jira. Debated the advantages of using predictive vs. adaptive planning methodologies in software development.
Challenges Faced:	Understanding the trade-offs between flexibility and fixed scheduling in software projects. Estimating effort and cost accurately in early project stages. Managing iteration planning in Agile while ensuring continuous delivery. Overcoming resistance to change when transitioning from traditional to Agile planning approaches.
Personal development activities:	Researched project planning methodologies such as CPM, PERT, and Agile roadmaps. Studied real-world project management cases to understand scheduling challenges. Practiced breaking down a sample project into WBS components for better planning.
Goals for the Next Week:	Study risk mitigation strategies in project planning. Explore case studies of successful Agile planning and execution in large-scale projects. Investigate the impact of project governance frameworks on software project success.